

Here's the full curation for **shy**, anchored to the passage sentence **"At that time, I was quite shy..."** I'm keeping the full **MCQ-ready master list** at the end.

SHY

1. Passage anchor

> "At that time, I was quite **shy** and tended to keep my head down in class."

Passage meaning

shy = nervous, uncomfortable, or lacking confidence in social situations, especially with unfamiliar people or when speaking in front of others

害羞的；靦腆的；不太敢表現自己的

Here, the speaker was afraid of saying the wrong thing, so **shy** means socially hesitant and lacking confidence.

Practice

1. I was very **shy** when I first joined the class.

我剛加入班級時非常**害羞**。

2. She is **shy** around new people but becomes talkative once she feels comfortable.

她在陌生人面前很**靦腆**，但熟悉後就會變得健談。

Core meanings of SHY

2. shy — nervous or uncomfortable with people

= feeling nervous or self-conscious in social situations

害羞的；靦腆的；怕生的

Examples

1. He is too **shy** to speak in front of the class.

他太**害羞**，不敢在全班面前說話。

2. She has always been a little **shy** with strangers.

她一直都有點**怕生**。

This is the central adjective meaning.

3. shy with / around someone

= uncomfortable or hesitant when interacting with particular people

在某人面前害羞；跟某人相處時拘謹

Examples

1. The child is **shy around adults**.
那個孩子在大人面前很**害羞**。
2. He was **shy with people he didn't know well**.
他在不熟的人面前很**拘謹**。

4. shy about something

= embarrassed or reluctant to talk about or show something

對.....感到害羞 / 不好意思

Examples

1. She is **shy about speaking English**.
她對講英文這件事很**不好意思 / 不自信**。
2. He was **shy about showing his work**.
他對展示自己的作品感到**害羞**。

5. too shy to do something

= so shy that you avoid or cannot bring yourself to do something

太害羞而不敢.....

Examples

1. I was **too shy to ask a question**.
我太**害羞，不敢問問題**。
2. She was **too shy to introduce herself**.
她太**害羞，不敢自我介紹**。

Very high-value pattern.

Reserved / socially quiet

6. shy — reserved and not very outgoing

= quiet and less likely to speak or attract attention

內向拘謹的；不愛出風頭的

Examples

1. He was a **shy, quiet student**.

他是一個**害羞安靜的學生**。

2. She has a naturally **shy personality**.

她天生個性比較**靦腆**。

This overlaps with **reserved**, but **shy** more strongly suggests social nervousness.

Reluctant / unwilling

7. shy away from something

= avoid something because of fear, nervousness, or lack of confidence

迴避；不敢面對；避開

Examples

1. Don't **shy away from difficult questions**.

不要**迴避困難的問題**。

2. She used to **shy away from public speaking**.

她以前會**避開公開演講**。

This is a highly useful phrasal verb.

8. shy away from doing something

= avoid doing something because it feels difficult, risky, or uncomfortable

因害怕 / 不自在而不敢做.....

Examples

1. He ****shied away from taking responsibility****.

他****不敢承擔責任 / 迴避責任****。

2. She no longer ****shies away from expressing her opinion****.

她現在不再****害怕表達自己的看法****。

Animals

9. shy — easily frightened

= easily startled or frightened, especially of an animal

****容易受驚的 ; 膽小的****

Examples

1. The horse is very ****shy**** around traffic.

那匹馬在車流附近很****容易受驚****。

2. Some wild animals are naturally ****shy****.

有些野生動物天生比較****膽小怕人****。

This is distinct from human social shyness.

10. shy at something

Especially of a horse:

= suddenly move away in fear from something

****受驚躲閃****

Examples

1. The horse ****shied at the sudden noise****.

馬被突如其來的聲音嚇到 , ****猛地躲開****。

2. The pony ****shied at the umbrella****.

小馬看到雨傘時****受驚閃避****。

Lower-priority but established.

Lacking / short of

11. shy of + amount

= slightly less than a particular number, amount, distance, etc.

不到；差一點；略少於

Examples

1. The total was just **shy of \$1,000**.

總額**不到一千美元**。

2. The journey took just **shy of three hours**.

旅程花了**不到三個小時**。

This is a major distinct sense.

12. just shy of

= slightly less than

略低於；差一點到

Examples

1. He is **just shy of six feet tall**.

他身高**略低於六英尺**。

2. Sales reached **just shy of one million units**.

銷量達到**接近但不到一百萬件**。

Very common in measurements and reporting.

Missing / deficient

13. shy of something

= lacking enough of something

缺少；不足

Examples

1. The team is still ****shy of experience****.

這個團隊仍然****缺乏經驗****。

2. We are a few people ****shy of the required number****.

我們距離所需人數還****少幾個人****。

This use is less common than ****short of****, but established.

Verb: throw / fling

14. shy — verb: throw something suddenly

= throw or fling something, often quickly

****投擲；猛扔****

Examples

1. He ****shied a stone**** at the fence.

他朝籬笆****扔了一塊石頭****。

2. The boy ****shied a ball**** across the yard.

那個男孩把球****猛地扔過院子****。

This sense is old-fashioned or regional and low priority for general learners.

Related forms

15. shyness

= the quality or feeling of being shy

****害羞；羞怯****

Examples

1. Her ****shyness**** made public speaking difficult.

她的****害羞****讓公開演講變得很困難。

2. He gradually overcame his ****shyness****.

他逐漸克服了自己的****羞怯****。

16. shyly

= in a shy or hesitant way

****害羞地；靦腆地****

Examples

1. She smiled ****shyly****.

她****害羞地****笑了。

2. He ****shyly**** introduced himself.

他****有些靦腆地****自我介紹。

17. self-conscious

Not a direct derivative, but an important near-neighbour:

= overly aware of yourself and worried about how others see you

****不自在的；在意別人眼光的****

This often overlaps with ****shy**** in social situations.

High-value expressions

18. camera-shy

= uncomfortable being photographed or appearing on camera

****怕上鏡的；不喜歡被拍照的****

Examples

1. He is extremely ****camera-shy****.

他非常****怕上鏡****。

2. She used to be ****camera-shy**** as a teenager.

她青少年時很****不喜歡面對鏡頭****。

19. publicity-shy / media-shy

= avoiding public or media attention

****低調、不喜歡曝光的****

Examples

1. The writer is famously ****publicity-shy****.
那位作家出了名地****不喜歡公開曝光****。
2. He remains ****media-shy**** despite his success.
儘管很成功，他仍然****不愛面對媒體****。

More formal/media-oriented.

Key contrasts

20. shy vs introverted

****shy****

= nervous or uncomfortable in social situations

****害羞；社交上不自在****

****introverted****

= tending to prefer lower-stimulation environments and inward-focused activity

****內向的****

A person can be:

* shy but not introverted

* introverted but not shy

They are not synonyms.

21. shy vs quiet

****quiet****

= not speaking much / not making much noise

****安靜的；話少的****

****shy****

= socially nervous or hesitant

****害羞的****

Compare:

> She is **quiet**, but not shy.

> 她話不多，但並不害羞。

> He is **shy**, so he rarely speaks in large groups.

> 他很害羞，所以在人多的場合很少說話。

22. shy vs reserved

reserved

= not openly expressing feelings or opinions; restrained

拘謹的；含蓄的

shy

= nervous or self-conscious socially

害羞的

A reserved person may simply prefer privacy without feeling nervous.

23. shy vs timid

timid

= lacking courage or easily frightened

膽怯的；畏縮的

shy

= socially hesitant or easily embarrassed

害羞的

Compare:

> She is **shy around strangers**.

> 她在陌生人面前很害羞。

> He was too **timid** to challenge the decision.

> 他太膽怯，不敢挑戰那個決定。

Timid is broader and often more negative.

24. shy vs embarrassed

****shy****

= general tendency or feeling of social hesitation

****embarrassed****

= uncomfortable because of a specific awkward or humiliating event

****尷尬的；難為情的****

Compare:

> I'm ****shy around new people****.

> 我在陌生人面前會害羞。

> I was ****embarrassed after forgetting her name****.

> 我忘了她名字後很尷尬。

25. shy vs ashamed

****ashamed****

= feeling guilt or shame because of something morally or personally negative

****羞愧的****

****shy****

does not imply guilt.

So:

> shy student = 害羞的學生

> ashamed student = 感到羞愧的學生

Very different.

Grammar patterns

26. shy + around / with + people

* shy around strangers

* shy with new classmates

****在.....面前害羞****

27. shy about + noun / -ing

- * shy about speaking
- * shy about her accent

****對.....不好意思 / 缺乏自信****

28. too shy to + verb

> She was too shy to speak.

= ****她太害羞，不敢說話。****

29. shy away from + noun / -ing

> Don't shy away from challenges.

= ****不要因害怕或不自在而迴避挑戰。****

Meaning map

The central human sense of ****shy**** is:

****social hesitation caused by nervousness, self-consciousness, or lack of confidence****

From this develop:

Human social behavior

shy student

→ ****害羞的；靦腆的****

Avoidance

shy away from something

→ ****因不安而迴避****

Animals

shy horse

→ **容易受驚的**

A separate quantitative branch is:

Amount

just shy of 100

→ **略低於 / 不到100**

And a low-priority verb branch is:

Throw

shy a stone

→ **投擲**

These should be kept clearly separate.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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shy — social	在與人互動時因緊張、不自信或怕被注意而顯得害羞 / 靦腆
shy around/with someone	在某人或某類人面前感到拘謹、不自在
shy about something	對某件事感到不好意思、缺乏自信或不願公開表現
too shy to do	因害羞或缺乏社交自信而不敢做某事
shy personality/person	個性較害羞、拘謹、不愛成為注意焦點的人
shy away from something	因害怕、不安或缺乏信心而迴避某事
shy — animal	動物容易受驚、怕人或對刺激反應敏感
shy at something — animal	動物因受驚而突然閃避某物
shy of + amount	數量、距離、時間等略低於某個數值；不到
just shy of	接近某數值但仍稍微不足
shy of something — lacking	在某項資源、條件或數量上不足
shyness	害羞、羞怯或社交上缺乏自信的特質
shyly	以害羞、靦腆或拘謹的方式
camera-shy	不喜歡被拍照、上鏡或面對鏡頭
media/publicity-shy	不喜歡公開曝光或面對媒體注意

Passage recap

> “At that time, I was quite **shy** and tended to keep my head down in class.”

Here:

****shy**** = ****socially nervous, hesitant, and lacking confidence****

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****害羞的****

* ****靦腆的****

* ****不太敢表現自己的****

* contextually: ****當時我很害羞，在課堂上總是不太敢出聲****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****shy****

= ****nervous or uncomfortable in social situations and therefore reluctant to speak or attract attention****

****害羞的；靦腆的；社交上拘謹的****

It does not mean ****“slightly less than”**** here, as in:

> ****just shy of 100****

> = ****差一點到100 / 不到100****

That quantitative sense is completely separate.